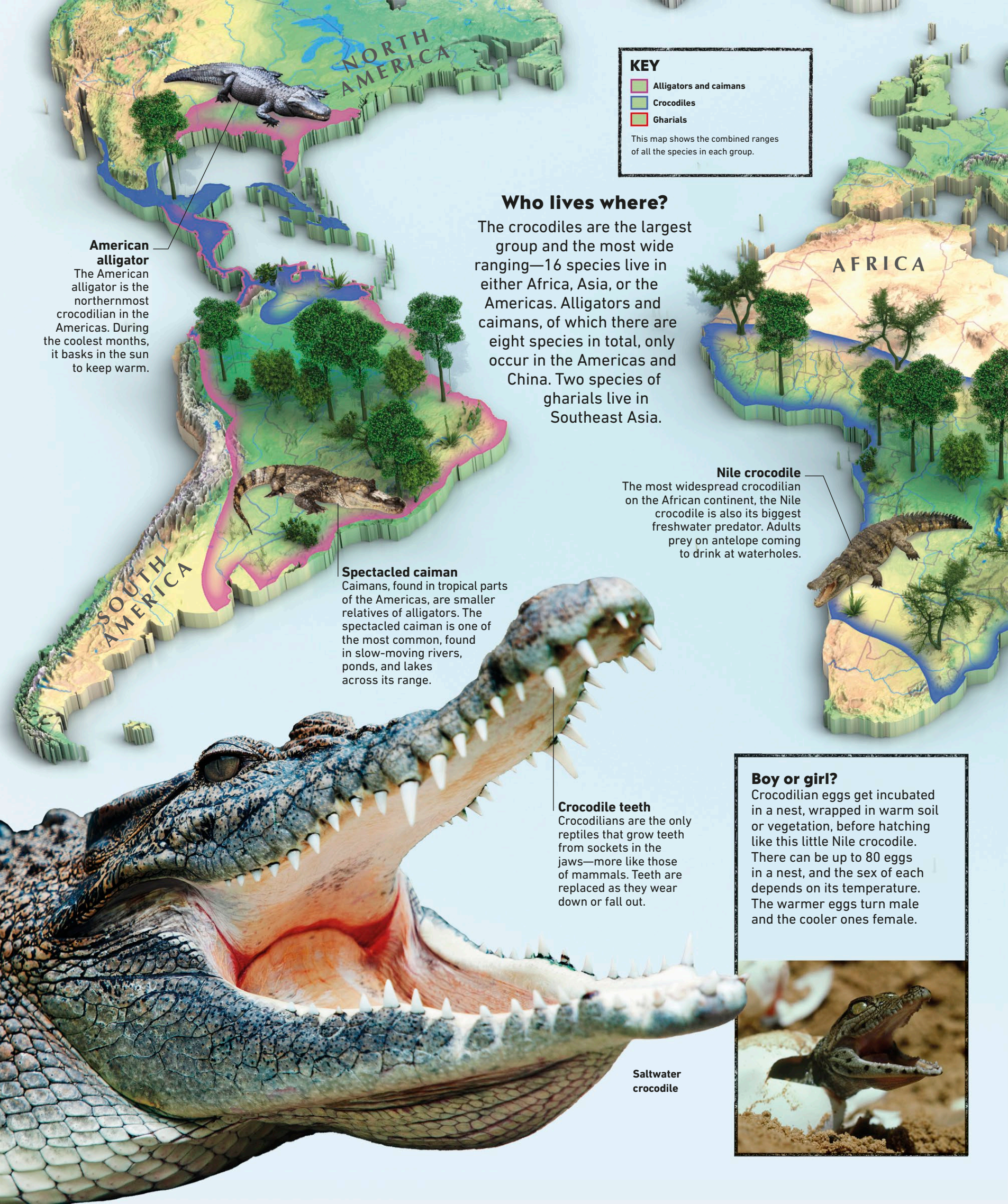




KEY

- Alligators and caimans
- Crocodiles
- Gharials

This map shows the combined ranges of all the species in each group.

Who lives where?

The crocodiles are the largest group and the most wide ranging—16 species live in either Africa, Asia, or the Americas. Alligators and caimans, of which there are eight species in total, only occur in the Americas and China. Two species of gharials live in Southeast Asia.

American alligator

The American alligator is the northernmost crocodilian in the Americas. During the coolest months, it basks in the sun to keep warm.

Spectacled caiman

Caimans, found in tropical parts of the Americas, are smaller relatives of alligators. The spectacled caiman is one of the most common, found in slow-moving rivers, ponds, and lakes across its range.

Nile crocodile

The most widespread crocodilian on the African continent, the Nile crocodile is also its biggest freshwater predator. Adults prey on antelope coming to drink at waterholes.

Crocodile teeth

Crocodilians are the only reptiles that grow teeth from sockets in the jaws—more like those of mammals. Teeth are replaced as they wear down or fall out.

Boy or girl?

Crocodilian eggs get incubated in a nest, wrapped in warm soil or vegetation, before hatching like this little Nile crocodile. There can be up to 80 eggs in a nest, and the sex of each depends on its temperature. The warmer eggs turn male and the cooler ones female.

Saltwater crocodile

